DOSM DATATHON

DOSM DATATHON 2026

DOSM DATATHON 2026

Organised by the
Department of Statistics
Malaysia (DOSM)

EMPOWERING TALENT. INNOVATING DATA. SHAPING TOMORROW.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

DOSM DATATHON

DOSM DATATHON 2026

> About Us 01

> Timeline 02

> Participants Workflow 03

> Competition Overview 04

> SDGs Involved 05

> Competition Stages 06

> Rules and Regulations 08

> Submission Rules 12

> Written Report Format 13

> Dashboard 14

> Video Presentation 17

> Live Pitching Guidelines 19

> Prizes & Special Awards 20

> Contact Info 21

DOSM DATATHON 2026

KEMENTERIAN EKONOMI
JABATAN PERANGKAAN MALAYSIA

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ABOUT US

DOSM Datathon 2026 is a premier national datathon organised by the Department of Statistics Malaysia (DOSM) in conjunction with the annual celebration of Hari Statistik Negara, observed on 20 October each year. The competition brings together diploma and undergraduate students from higher education institutions across Malaysia to develop innovative solutions using artificial intelligence, machine learning, and data analytics.

Guided by the theme, "Leveraging ML and AI to Develop Innovative Solutions for Sustainable Tourism Industry in Malaysia," participants are challenged to transform official statistics into impactful solutions that address real-world issues across the economic, social, environmental, and governance dimensions of sustainable tourism. The competition aims to foster innovation, collaboration, critical thinking, and data-driven decision-making among future data professionals.

Established in 1949, the Department of Statistics Malaysia (DOSM) is the nation's official statistical agency responsible for collecting, producing, and disseminating official statistics. Through initiatives such as DOSM Datathon 2026, DOSM continues to promote data literacy, encourage the use of official statistics, and inspire the next generation of data innovators to contribute towards Malaysia's sustainable development.

20 Oktober

DOSM DATATHON 2026

TIMELINE

DOSM DATATHON 2026

3 August 2026

Promotion Begins

10 - 28 August 2026

Participation Registration Period

8 September 2026

The Opening Ceremony & Competition Briefing

8 - 22 September 2026

Project Development & Submission Period

23 Sept - 2 October 2026

Shortlisting Process

5 October 2026

Top 10 Finalists Announcement

19 October 2026

Top 10 Live Pitching at Auditorium Tun Azizan Zainul Abidin (TAZA), Presint 3, Putrajaya

20 October 2026

Closing Ceremony & Winners Announcement at Auditorium TAZA, Presint 3, Putrajaya

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DOSM DATATHON
2026

PARTICIPANTS WORKFLOW

01

8 - 22 September 2026

- Participants must submit three final deliverables: a project report, a dashboard, and a video presentation.
- Participants must use open-source datasets that align with their project, competition theme, and relevant SDGs, as no datasets will be provided directly.
- All deliverables must be submitted online through the designated Google Drive folder, and each team must also complete the Google Form to confirm that the required files have been successfully uploaded.

02

23 September - 2 October 2026

Evaluation Phase:

- Judges will assess all submissions using the official Preliminary Round Scoring Rubric.
- Top 10 teams are shortlisted for live pitching on 19 October 2026.
- Finalists will be notified with pitching details.

03

19 October 2026

Top 10 Live Pitching at Putrajaya:

- Finalists will present to the judges for 10 minutes, followed by a 5 minutes Q&A session with the judges.
- Pitch will be broadcast online through DOSM's official platform.
- Final scores will be based on the quality and innovation of the project, as well as the effectiveness of the team's pitching performance.

20 Oktober

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DOSM DATATHON
2026

COMPETITION OVERVIEW

THEME

Leveraging Machine Learning (ML) & Artificial Intelligence (AI) for sustainable tourism in Malaysia

CHALLENGE

Leveraging ML & AI to develop innovative solutions for sustainable tourism industry in Malaysia.

PARTICIPANTS STRUCTURE

- Each team must consist of FOUR (4) Malaysian students and ONE (1) academic advisor from the same Public Higher Education Institution (IPTA) or Private Higher Education Institution (IPTS).
- All participants must be active diploma or undergraduate students enrolled in Malaysian universities at the time of the DOSM Datathon 2026 competition.
- Participants will gain access to all events organized under DOSM Datathon 2026 upon completion of the registration and payment process.
- The Top 10 teams that qualify for the Final Round must maintain the same registered members as in the Preliminary Round. No changes in team composition are allowed.

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SDGs INVOLVED

MALAYSIA DATA
INNOVATION TALENT 2026

DATA
FOR GOOD

INNOVATE
FOR IMPACT

EMPOWER
COMMUNITIES

SUSTAIN
OUR FUTURE

SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

8 DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH

9 INDUSTRY, INNOVATION AND INFRASTRUCTURE

12 RESPONSIBLE CONSUMPTION AND PRODUCTION

14 LIFE BELOW WATER

DATA. INNOVATION. IMPACT.

BUILDING A SUSTAINABLE MALAYSIA TOGETHER.

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Competition Stages

Participants will first compete in the **Preliminary Round.**
From there, 10 teams will be selected to advance to the **Final Round.**
The details of each round are outlined below:

01

PRELIMINARY ROUND

The Preliminary Round is conducted remotely, with all submissions made online.

02

FINAL ROUND

Top 10 finalist teams advance to the Final Round.

REAL CHALLENGE

DATA INNOVATION

BIG IMPACT

PRELIMINARY ROUND

1. The required submissions for the Preliminary Round are a project report, a dashboard, and a video presentation.
2. Participants must complete their projects using any hardware and software of their choice.
3. All final products must strictly follow the submission guidelines (refer to the sections from Submission Rules until Video Presentation).
4. All submissions will be evaluated by professional judges from the Department of Statistics Malaysia (DOSM).
5. The submission period is from 8 to 22 September 2026.
6. Submissions must be uploaded to Google Drive according to the instructions stated in Submission Rules No. 3.
7. Late or incomplete submissions will result in automatic disqualification.
8. The top 10 finalist teams will be selected for the Final Round based on a rank-based evaluation system. All judges' decisions are final.
9. The scoring rubric for the live pitching session can be accessed through: RUBRIK PERMARKAHAN DOSM DATATHON 2026 - PUSINGAN AWAL

20 Oktober

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DOSM DATATHON 2026

Competition Stages (cont...)

Participants will first compete in the **Preliminary Round.**
From there, 10 teams will be selected to advance to the **Final Round.**
The details of each round are outlined below:

01

PRELIMINARY ROUND

The Preliminary Round is conducted remotely, with all submissions made online.

02

FINAL ROUND

Top 10 finalist teams advance to the Final Round.

FINAL ROUND (PHYSICAL)

1. The Top 10 finalist teams with the highest scores from the preliminary round will advance to the Final Round.
2. Finalists will be notified via email with further instructions.
3. The final round will be conducted physically at Auditorium Tun Azizan Zainul Abidin (TAZA), Presint 3, Putrajaya.
4. Finalists must present their Preliminary Round project and submit only the Dashboard and Presentation Slides for the live pitching session.
5. The final presentation session will be 20 minutes per team, divided as follows:
   - 10 minutes: Presentation
   - 5 minutes: Q&A with the judges
   - 5 minutes: Scoring and transition between teams
6. Further details regarding the technical aspects of the Final Round will be announced later.
7. The scoring rubric for the live pitching session can be accessed through: RUBRIK PERMARKAHAN DOSM DATATHON 2026 - PUSINGAN AKHIR

REAL CHALLENGE

DATA INNOVATION

BIG IMPACT

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DOSM DATATHON 2026

Rules and Regulations

1

ELIGIBILITY

Participation is open to Diploma and Undergraduate students from Public (IPTS) and Private (IPTS) Higher Education Institutions in Malaysia. All participants must be Malaysian citizens.

2

TEAM COMPOSITION

Each team must consist of FOUR (4) students from the same university and ONE (1) academic advisor.

3

TEAM MEMBER CHANGES

No team changes are allowed after the registration deadline unless approved by the organising committee under exceptional circumstances.

4

SUPERVISOR ROLE

The academic advisor is expected to provide guidance and advisory support only, and not to be directly involved in the product development.

5

REGISTRATION & FEES

Registration must be completed through the official DOSM Datathon 2026 website. No entry fee required.

6

MANDATORY WHATSAPP GROUP PARTICIPATION

Upon confirmation of registration, live pitching participants will join the official WhatsApp community 'Participants DOSM Datathon 2026' using the provided link. All official announcements and updates will be made through this community.

7

MANDATORY ATTENDANCE

All participants are required to be present and actively involved in every session organised throughout the competition.

20 Oktober

DOSM DATATHON 2026

Rules and Regulations (cont...)

8

DEVELOPMENT TIMELINE

All projects must be completed within the competition's specified timeframe. Late submissions will not be accepted or evaluated.

9

DATA SOURCES

Participants must use open and publicly accessible datasets. The use of fabricated, simulated, or fictional data is strictly prohibited. All data must be authentic, reliable, and sourced from credible platforms. Recommended data sources include (but are not limited to):

- OpenDOSM (Department of Statistics Malaysia)
- eStatistik
- data.gov.my (Malaysian Government Open Data Portal)
- World Bank Open Data
- Monthly Highlights and Statistics Dataset (Bank Negara Malaysia)
- UN Data

Extra mark(s) will be awarded for using Malaysian official data (e.g. OpenDOSM, eStatistik, StatsDW), subject to judging criteria.

10

TOOLS & EQUIPMENT

Participants may use any hardware and software of their choice, but must provide and use their own ICT equipment throughout the competition.

11

ORIGINALITY AND USE OF THIRD-PARTY MATERIALS

All submitted work must be the original work of the team. Teams may use third-party libraries, frameworks, pre-trained models, and openly licensed datasets as long as they clearly cite and list each external resource in the Project Report and reproducibility package, and also document how those resources were used and integrated. Submissions that copy, plagiarise, or otherwise use proprietary intellectual property without licence or attribution will be disqualified.

12

REQUIRED SUBMISSIONS

Each team must submit:

a) A dashboard in PDF format, accompanied by the source file (e.g., .pbix, .xlsm, etc.)
b) A recorded presentation video
c) A project report using the template provided by the organisers

20 Oktober

DOSM DATATHON

DOSM DATATHON
2026

Rules and Regulations (cont...)

13

FINAL SUBMISSION

Once submitted, no changes or resubmissions are allowed. The final version will be evaluated as is.

14

DASHBOARD ACCESSIBILITY

The final product must be delivered in dashboard form and must remain accessible until the evaluation process is complete.

15

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY RIGHTS

Participants retain full ownership of their projects. However, the organizers reserve non-exclusive rights to showcase, publish, or exhibit the project for promotional or educational use, with proper credit to the team.

16

ETHICAL DATA USE

Participants must not use personally identifiable or confidential data without proper authorization. Any misuse of sensitive information will result in disqualification.

17

PERSONAL DATA PROTECTION

All personal data shared with the organisers will be securely stored and used only according to competition rules, unless explicit consent is given for other purposes.

18

INAPPROPRIATE CONTENT PROHIBITED

Submissions containing offensive, violent, defamatory, or insulting content especially against the organisers or any unauthorised copyrighted material will be disqualified.

19

PROHIBITION OF HARMFUL SOFTWARE

Submissions must be free from harmful elements such as viruses, trojans, spyware, or any code that could damage or disrupt systems.

20

VIOLATION OF RULES

The organisers reserve the right to disqualify or cancel any team's entry if rules or submission requirements are violated.

20 Oktober

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DOSM DATATHON
2026

Rules and Regulations (cont...)

21

LIABILITY DISCLAIMER

The organizers will not be held responsible for any incidents, health issues, damages, or losses incurred during participation.

22

FINAL DECISION BY JUDGES

All decisions by the judging panel, including the selection of winners, are final and cannot be appealed.

23

E-CERTIFICATE ELIGIBILITY

E-certificates of participation will be issued only to participants who submit their final products within the deadline. Certificates will be emailed after the competition ends.

20 Oktober

DOSM DATATHON

DOSM DATATHON
2026

Submission Rules

1. Each team must develop and submit three mandatory documents: **a written report, a dashboard**, and **a video presentation** using the datasets accessible via the website **https://open.dosm.gov.my,** or other trustworthy websites. However, participants are also permitted and have the flexibility to use data from any other reliable source of their choosing. The raw data used must originate exclusively from within Malaysia. Data acquired from other countries may only be employed to support a statement.

2. All files submitted at this stage will be evaluated by professional judges before being shortlisted as the **Top 10 finalists.**

3. Each team will receive an email with access to a specific Google Drive folder for uploading all the mandatory documents via their registered email starting from **8 September 2026** until **22 September 2026,** with the final deadline at **5:00 PM on 22 September 2026**. If any team members are unable to access the Google Drive folder by the stated date, please contact the management bureau at **jkpenjuriandatathon@gmail.com.**

   Participants must **adhere to all submission rules** to avoid the deduction of points.

4. Please ensure that the **Google Form** is completed no later than 11:59 PM on 22 September 2026 to confirm that all required documents have been uploaded to the designated Google Drive folder.

20 Oktober

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DOSM DATATHON 2026

WRITTEN REPORT FORMAT

FONT	: Times New Roman, size 12
SPACING	: 1.5
ALIGNMENT	: Justify
CONTENTS OF THE REPORT	1. Front Page (participants must use the provided template and edit it with the required information) 2. Table of Contents 3. Introduction (background of the study, problem statement, objectives) 4. Literature Review 5. Methodology (method of data analysis) 6. Findings (result, including information architecture/ solution approach, visually appealing aids) 7. Output (dashboard) 8. Conclusion 9. References
MAXIMUM NUMBER OF PAGES	: 25, excluding the front page, table of contents, and references.
SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS	• Please use the provided front page responsibly and avoid misuse. • The written report must be saved and submitted in PDF format. • The template for the written report can be accessed through the link attached below : TEMPLATE WRITTEN REPORT DOSM DATATHON 2026
FILE NAMING CONVENTION	: TeamName_Datathon2026_Report.pdf.

20 Oktober

DOSM DATATHON

DOSM DATATHON
2026

DASHBOARD

1 DASHBOARD CONTENT

1.1 The dashboard must include all relevant and comprehensive information, such as charts, graphs, maps, and key insights to support the analysis and storytelling.

1.2 Data visualisation should be clear, accurate, and easy to interpret, providing meaningful insights for decision-making.

2 SCREENSHOT USAGE

2.1 Screenshots, if included in the report, must be high-resolution and accurately reflect the actual dashboard.

2.2 Screenshots cannot replace the actual dashboard file, they are for presentation purposes only.

3 WORKABLE DASHBOARD REQUIREMENT (MANDATORY)

3.1 Participants are required to submit a fully functional (workable) dashboard that allows the judges to open, explore, and interact with it during evaluation.

3.2 The dashboard must be free from technical errors, with all filters, links, and interactive features fully operational.

3.3 Accepted file formats include, but are not limited to:

- i. Power Bi: .pbix
- ii. Excel Interactive Dashboard: .xlsm/xlsx (with formulas, macros and interactivity intact)
- iii. Tableau: .twbx
- iv. Other interactive formats approved by the organizers.

20 Oktober

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DOSM DATATHON
2026

DASHBOARD (cont...)

4 SUBMISSION PACKAGE STRUCTURE

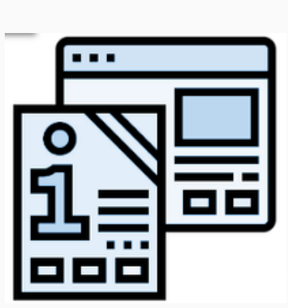
Participants must submit both a static and interactive version of the dashboard, along with supporting files.

4.1 Static Version:
A PDF file showing the final dashboard layout for documentation purposes.

4.2 Interactive Version:
i. The original workable dashboard file (e.g., .pbix, .twbx, .xlsm), which can be opened and tested by the judges.
ii. Any clean/raw data files used in the analysis, if permitted.
iii. A README.txt file with instructions for running and navigating the dashboard.

4.3 Final submission must be compressed into a single ZIP/RAR file following this structure: TeamName_Datathon2026_Dashboard.zip
i. Dashboard.pdf
ii. Dashboard.pbix/Dashboard.xlsx/Dashboard.twbx
iii. Data.csv/Data.xlsx (if applicable)
iv. README.txt

5 README FILE GUIDELINES



The README.txt file must include:

5.1 Software name and version used (e.g., Power BI Desktop version, Strategy One Web version, Tableau Desktop version).

5.2 Step-by-step instructions to open and navigate the dashboard.

5.3 Any additional requirements such as plugins or add-ons (if needed).

5.4 Notes on limitations, assumptions, or special considerations for the dashboard.

20 Oktober

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DOSM DATATHON
2026

DASHBOARD (cont...)

6 FINAL NOTES

6.1 Ensure that the submitted dashboard works as intended without external dependencies that cannot be accessed by the judges.

6.2 All files must be well-organized and named clearly to avoid confusion.

6.3 Incomplete or non-functional submissions may be disqualified or penalized during judging.

20 Oktober

DOSM DATATHON 2026

VIDEO PRESENTATION

1 VIDEO DURATION

The presentation video must not exceed 10 minutes in length.

2 FILE SIZE

2.1 Ensure that the submitted dashboard works as intended without external dependencies that cannot be accessed by the judges.

2.2 Participants are encouraged to optimize video quality and compression to maintain clarity while keeping the file size manageable.

3 CONTENT REQUIREMENTS

3.1 The video must include the following elements in a clear and logical flow:

i. Introduction of the team and project title (within 1 minute)
ii. Problem statement and objectives
iii. Data sources and methodology
iv. Key findings and insights
v. Live demonstration of the interactive dashboard showing how it works and key features
vi. Conclusion and potential impact or scalability.

3.2 It should be concise and focused on the problem statement, methodology, key findings, and demonstration of the dashboard.

3.3 The dashboard shown in the video must be fully functional, with all interactive features demonstrated.

3.4 All visuals, text, and audio must be clear, professional, and easy to follow.

3.5 Avoid excessive background noise or poor audio quality.

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DOSM DATATHON
2026

VIDEO PRESENTATION (cont...)

4

FILE FORMAT AND SUBMISSION

4.1 The final video must be saved and submitted in MP4 format.

4.2 File naming convention: TeamName_Datathon2026_Video.mp4.

20 Oktober

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DOSM DATATHON
2026

LIVE PITCHING GUIDELINES

01 PRESENTATION FORMAT

Ensure the presentation is prepared using suitable software (e.g. PowerPoint, Google Slides, Canva).

02 DEVICE READINESS

Each team is responsible for bringing their own device for the session. Make sure the device is fully charged, HDMI-compatible, and the presentation is ready for smooth display.

03 PREPARATION TIME

Each team will be given 5 minutes to prepare before their turn. A member of the secretariat will escort the team outside the hall for final preparations and discussion.

04 PRESENTER

A maximum of two (2) presenters are allowed to present or pitch on behalf of the team.

05 PITCH DURATION

Each team is allocated a maximum of 10 minutes to deliver their pitch.

06 PITCH TIMING

- A bell will ring once to signal the start of the pitch.
- After 8 minutes, the bell will ring again, indicating the presenter has 2 minutes remaining.
- The final bell will ring twice, marking the end of the 10-minute pitch.

07 Q&A SESSION

Following the pitch, there will be a 5-minute Q&A session, during which the judges will ask questions.

20 Oktober

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PRIZES

1st Place	RM3,500
2nd Place	RM2,500
3rd Place	RM1,500
4th to 10th Place	RM300 per team

SPECIAL AWARDS

Pitching Excellence Award
(Individual)

Critical Thinking & Defence Award
(Team)

AI-Driven Innovation Award
(Team)

20 Oktober

DOSM DATATHON

DOSM DATATHON
2026

CONTACT INFO

For any inquiries, please contact us on:

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